

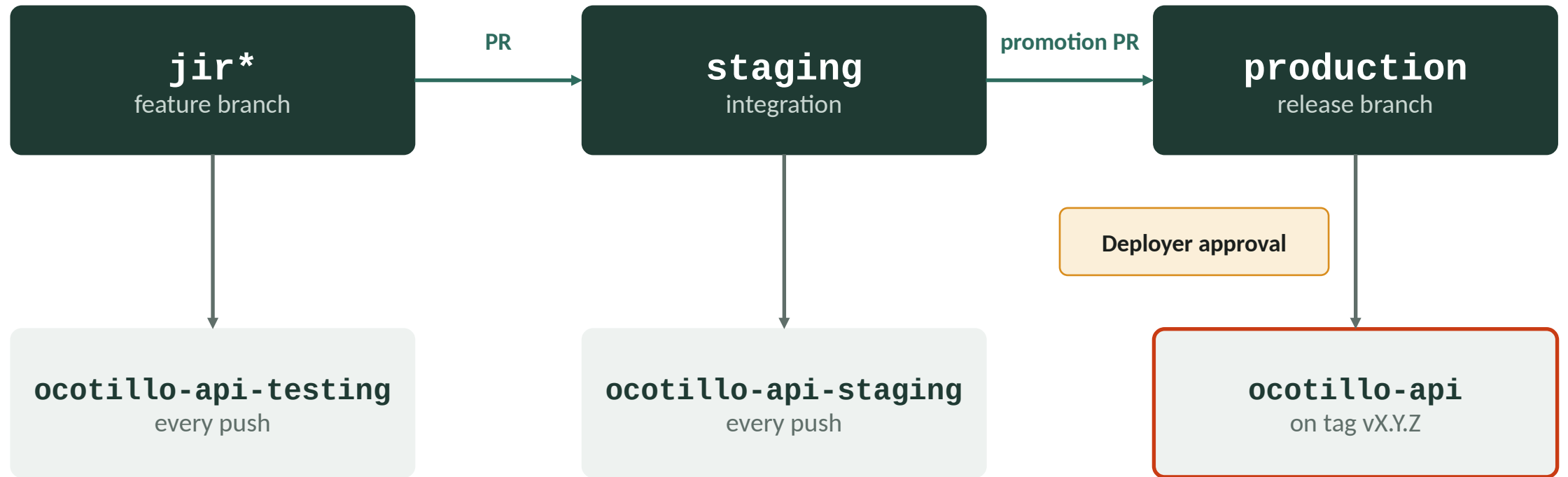


= a known failure point. Watch for these.

Deploying OcotilloAPI

How a release reaches production, and where it breaks

Three branches, three services



Only production is versioned. Staging deploys every push with no tag, so test the commit you plan to ship.

A release in ten steps

Before

- 1 Freeze staging until promotion merges
- 2 Back up Cloud SQL if data migrations ship
- 3 Note the serving version (rollback target)

Ship

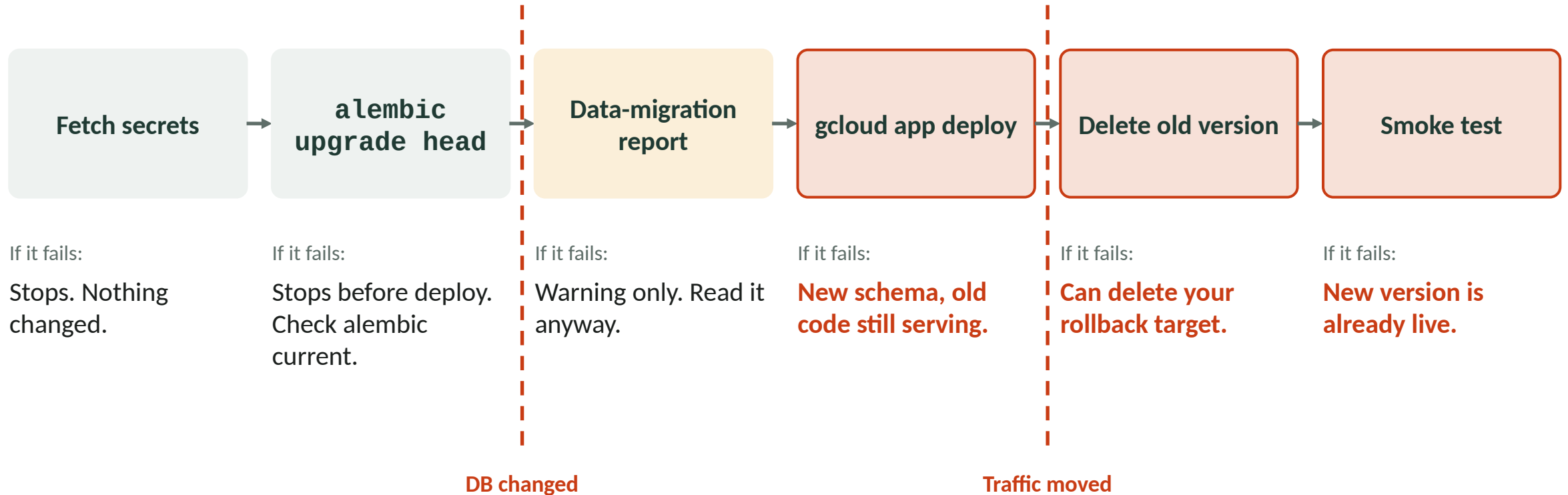
- 4 Merge promotion PR staging → production
- 5 Release PR merges itself
- 6 Confirm deploy-production ran, not skipped
- 7 Second Deployer approves

After

- 8 Run pending data migrations
- 9 Merge back-merge PR to staging
- 10 Promote the UI (API first)

! Red = has failed before, or can fail silently

Inside CD_production



A red smoke test means production is already broken. Roll back first, debug second.

Failure points: before anything changes



Staging moved

Anything merged after you tested ships untested. Freeze staging until the promotion merges.



Release PR stuck

Without FORWARD_MERGE_TOKEN it only logs a warning. Merge by hand, and someone else must approve.



Deploy silently skipped

An empty tag skips deploy-production and the run still shows green. Check the job ran.



Nobody can approve

Whoever triggered the run can't approve it. Have a second Deployer lined up.



Secret missing

A missing Secret Manager secret or accessor role fails the run. Safe: nothing changed yet.



Prerequisites not done

Authentik groups and Cloud SQL flags live outside the code. Set them up before you deploy.

Failure points: during and after



Schema ahead of code

Migrations run before the deploy. If the deploy fails, old code serves the new schema. Keep migrations additive.



App won't start

8 workers need F4_1G or instances OOM and churn. Bad auth config aborts startup.



Smoke test red

Traffic has already moved to the new version. Treat it as an incident and roll back.



No rollback target

Cleanup deletes the oldest non-serving version, usually the one you replaced.



Data migrations skipped

CD only warns. Features ship with empty or stale data until someone runs them.



Back-merge left open

Staging drifts from production and the next changelog is a mess. Merge it the same day.

Rolling back

Minutes

Code

Move traffic back to the previous version:

```
gcloud app services set-traffic \
  ocotillo-api --splits=<PREV>=1
```

Version deleted? Ship a revert as a hotfix.

Judgment call

Schema

Stays applied after a traffic switch.

Downgrade only if old code can't read it and the rollback must persist.

Backup only

Data migrations

No downgrade exists.

Restore the pre-release Cloud SQL backup. No backup, no way back.

Hotfix



Skip step 5 and staging no longer contains the fix. The next promotion can ship the bug again.

Before you merge the promotion PR

- ☐ CI and the staging smoke test are green on the commit you're shipping
- ☐ Staging is frozen
- ☐ Authentik, secrets and Cloud SQL prerequisites are in place
- ☐ Cloud SQL backup taken if data migrations ship
- ☐ Previous App Engine version noted and still exists
- ☐ A second Deployer is available to approve

Full runbook: [docs/deployment-runbook.md](#)